Nordic Basic Scientific Computing 2026

Finnish (+ friends) RSE Meetup

About the Event

The Finnish and friends RSE (Research Software Engineer) Meetup brings together people in Finland (and beyond) who develop or support research through software, data, and computing. Whether your title is RSE, scientist, data specialist, or IT support, if you're helping research through code or computational tools - this event is for you. This is also for you, the RSE enthusiast, who enjoys the coding part of research work more or just as much as the research part.

Why a Finnish RSE Meetup?

While Nordic-RSE connects the regional community, this Finnish meetup provides a national focus for collaboration and sharing. It helps us:

- Discuss challenges and opportunities specific to Finnish institutions and funding structures
- Strengthen local networks and identify national needs (training, recognition, career paths)
- Coordinate efforts between universities, research institutes, and infrastructure providers like CSC

This meetup complements the Nordic-RSE community by creating a space for practical cooperation within Finland, while staying connected to the wider Nordic and international RSE movements.

Who Should Join

- Researchers and research software engineers developing or maintaining research code
- Data and computing specialists supporting research workflows
- IT staff, educators, and research managers interested in improving research software practices
- Early-career researchers curious about RSE career paths

No formal RSE title is needed - if you develop, or support research software, you belong here.

Why Participate

By joining you can:

- Meet peers from across Finnish universities and research institutes
- Learn how RSE groups and initiatives are organized in Finland
- Share your own experiences, needs, and ideas for national cooperation
- Help shape the future of Finnish/Nordic RSE activities - training, recognition, and community events

Organizers

This part of the event is sponsored by the Society of Research Software Engineering. Therefore we can keep the registration for free and offer lunch, coffee and snacks during the event. For any questions, ideas or if you would like to join the organizing committee, please contact samantha.wittke@csc.fi .

Travel funding

Thanks to the Software Sustainability Institute we have some travel funding (travel + one night accomodation) available for you to visit the RSE-FI meetup (day 1+2).

More information at Travel funding for the RSE meetup

Good to know

The meetup is organized by Finnish members of Nordic-RSE with support from the Software Sustainability Institute (via SSI fellowship of Samantha Wittke). Facilities are provided by Aalto Scientific Computing (ASC).

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Scientific computing team meetup

About the event

This meetup is targeted towards people in local Scientific Computing (SciComp)/Research computing/Research Software Engineer support teams, for example university local HPC teams. We work in local capacity and are often overshadowed by the big national e-infrastructure providers (CSC, EuroHPC, etc) in attention and funding, yet we are the ones “on the ground” with the researchers. What’s our place in the world?

We have our own unique challenges and opportunities. This is a time we can talk together and learn from each other. (Others are of course welcome.) Maybe we can make a strategy for working together or getting some national funding?

Who should join?

For example, many of the teams that were part of the old Finnish Grid Infrastructure at univerities or local partners of the CodeRefinery collaboration. Really, if you work with Aalto Scientific Computing you are strongly invited and we’ll have some fun discussions. If you don’t, you are invited anyway.

Academic conferences usually don’t suit us, but we need a community. Our job is important and challenging, and we can’t do it alone. NoBSC is the right level for the networking we need to succeed at our jobs.

In this first iteration, we especially welcome people who support academic research through computing and data expertise in universities and research institutions, for example those in local HPC or RSE teams, cloud computing, and other computing services for researchers. But everyone is welcome: including those who might want these kind of jobs in the future.

Cool things and problems

Program ideas

Everyone will have a chance to (and be encouraged) to contribute to the session “Cool things and problems”. In this, each team presents three cool things they are doing, and three problems they are facing. We can then see.

We can especially talk about:

- Local resources and teams in a time when computing is becoming more centralized.
- Local services we run, how they compare to national services.
- Advantages and disadvantages of being positioned locally.
- What types of infrastructure funding we could apply for to increase our benefit or make (inter-)national collaborations. (Dedicated session: Wednesday afternoon)

Good to know

There is no registration fee, but also no food, snacks, coffe, and dinner provided for this part of the event. We will have to divide into smaller groups for lunch and dinners and distribute to various restaurants.

Organizers

Richard Darst (richard.darst atsign aalto.fi) is organizing this half.

Practical info

Cool things and problems

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Practical info

Location

Dipoli building, Aalto University Campus, (Espoo), Helsinki Area. If you search `Dipoli` in a map service it should find it, the address is `Otakaari 24, 02150 Espoo`.

The main room is “Palaver” and there should be signs pointing you that direction (it’s also exactly marked on the map below). **If you arrive for lunch** you can find us on the 2nd floor Metso restaurant (not the Reima student restaurant that is next to it).

FAQ

Questions from attendees will be placed here for your reference:

- .
- .
- .

Food

For the Finnish and Friends RSE meetup on Monday/Tuesday we will have food available according to dietary restrictions provided during registration. For others we will have a reservation at restaurants in the campus area. These restaurants can generally cater to all common diets, including vegetarian, vegan, gluten free, and lactose free. There are also two grocery stores at the metro station (*A* entrance).

Map

Map

See full screen

Tourist information and other activities

Wikivoyage Helsinki is usually pretty accurate and has information about the area and other sights to see.

Hotels

There are various hotels within easy walking distance. We don't have any particular discounts. "Radison Blu Otaniemi" is the default location for university visitors. Other hotels in Helsinki downtown are fine also, the metro trip is 11 minutes (and costs ~3 euros).

Arrival

tldr: Aalto University is at the "Aalto University" metro stop. An "ABC" ticket manages the train from airport AND metro (and trams, busses, etc).

Bus, Train, etc. within Finland: You probably know how to get to the center of Helsinki. Follow public transit below.

Air: Helsinki Airport. Between the airport and Aalto University, plan for max 1.5 hours (less than one hour is possible if you are efficient). From the airport, follow signs to the train station. Board a train and immediately use a contactless payment card to buy an ABC ticket at a card reader; this will get you all the way to the university (see public transport). Take the first train that comes (either way gets to downtown in about the same time). From the main station, walk to the connected metro station. Take a metro to the stop Aalto University (direction Tapiola or Kivenlahti), then continue in section "public transport" below.

Private vehicle: There isn't free parking, but there are paid lots around.

Public transport: The public transport system is good and easy to use. The metro stop name is "Aalto University" and the A exit is closer to us. Tickets can be bought at ticket machines, or via the "HSL App". Aalto University is in the zone B, downtown is in the zone A, the airport in zone C, and tickets last a bit more than an hour and work on any public bus, train, metro, or tram (and as many transfers as you need). AB zone tickets cost about 3€.

Ferry: From Tallinn or Stockholm, there are ferries. Expect well under an hour to get from the ferry harbors to Aalto University. Take trams to the metro, but from each harbor walking to the metro is reasonable (not too far and nice walks). (Some attendees are also attending the Nordic e-infrastructure Conference in Tallinn on 27-29 May, they will be taking ferries from Tallinn the evening of 29 May. More info to be announced)

If coming from airport: use single tickets, day tickets not worth it even with one extra trip to/from downtown.

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Code of conduct

Attendees are expected to follow the Aalto University code of conduct. Realisically you won't read it, so here the general idea :

- There will be attendees at a wide variety of points in their RSE/SciComp career. Try to understand them and help them go.
- There will be attendees who know more or fewer other attendees. Take active steps to include them in your conversations:
  - Leave spaces in your circle for others to join, if you see someone hovering, invite them in and fill them in on what you are talking about.
  - Give special attention to understanding who is in your discussion groups and making sure you are talking at the right level.
- This is a bottom-up event to support your networking. Please help out if see something to improve and you have time and ability.
- Tell Richard or Samantha if you need something.

About

Organizers

- Richard Darst, Aalto University (co-lead, RC/SciComp part)
- Samantha Wittke, CSC - IT Center for Science (co-lead, RSE-FI)
- Luca Ferranti, Aalto University
- Ina Pöhner, University of Eastern Finland
- Local volunteers: open

The organizers welcome others to take part in planning, either in short or long term. We communicate via the CodeRefinery chat, #NoBSC channel. This is the same place that Nordic-RSE people hang out.

History of NoBSC

You could say this event was first inspired when Richard Darst went to the Nordic e-infrastructure Collaboration conference in 2017. This event had a variety of infrastructure and open science people not advertising why their stuff was so good, but discussion how to make things better. (At least that's what it looks like with rose-colored glasses looking back.) This also kicked off the collaboration between ASC and CodeRefinery (a NeIC project dedicated to teaching basic software tools for researchers), which continues to this day.

CodeRefinery didn't feel like a collaboration not between organizations, but between the people in the trenches directly helping or users. This was an extremely productive collaboration, not just in the main teaching but in connecting people together to talk about their other jobs besides teaching.

In 2019, we had a meeting it Helsinki called Nordic HPC, basically a lot of the CodeRefinery

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- Aalto Scientific Computing (Science-IT): Staff time, sponsoring all facilities
- CSC - IT Center for Science (EuroCC2 project): Staff time
- Software Sustainability Institute (through fellowship of Samantha Wittke): Travel funding, planning support
- [Society of Research Software Engineering](https://society-rse.org/): Catering support

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In 2019, we had a meeting it Helsinki called Nordic HPC, basically a lot of the CodeRefinery staff who were supporters of smaller university-based computing clusters. We enjoyed talking and sharing ideas, but soon we became closer together because we were all working online, and our collaboration was focused on online events.

Now, in 2025, we are trying to meet again in person. Hopefully there are the best parts from NeIC conferences, NeIC all-hands meetings, and NordicHPC, with even more people welcome to attend.

In addition to the SciComp team meetup, we have noticed that Research Software Engineering community, or "researchers who code" appreciate the connection to each other too - and there is a lot of connections and career movement between the two groups. Samantha's fellowship with the Software Sustainability Institute looks at exactly that. Part of the fellowship is the contribution to the international RSE survey to get to know the Finnish and Nordic community needs a bit better. A short lunch meeting of RSE enthusiasts in Espoo to celebrate the international RSE day on October 9th 2025 was a good start to connect. For the Finnish RSE meetup, we aim to also get together RSE enthusiasts from all over the country, share what we do, learn from each other and also learn about the needs and wishes of the community.

Call for contributions

The theme of this conference is how we actually work and "the problems we found along the way", not "advertising our product". You can present ideas, what you couldn't do, things you need advice on, and so on. You can request time slots for lightning talks, normal talks, posters or suggest a discussion session. If there are too many long talk requests, we will open a voting for the time to not have to decline any submitted talks. Only the length may change.

RSE-FI vs SciComp teams

You can submit to either part in advance, but

- RSE-FI is more focused on advanced submissions
- SciComp teams is more focused on being an unconference (we collect ideas dynamically during the meeting and allocate time then)

Selection process: We will review all submissions to make sure they align with the spirit of the event. Our goal is to accept as many contributions as possible. If there are too many long talks submitted, our plan is to let attendees vote and allocate time slots based on those votes. When submitting, please keep your abstract concise and accessible to a general audience.

In short: Your contribution will most likely be accepted, the main question is how much time you'll have to present.

You'll be able to submit talks, demos, or posters you'd like to present.

You will get to know about the length of your talk on January 21.

Contribution inspirations

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communicate in the CodeRefinery chat, #NoBSC channel. This is the same place that Nordic-RSE people hang out.

Abstract submission link

https://indico.neicnordic.org/event/284/abstracts/

Submit a contribution

Deadline for submissions to get into the program is January 20 end of day in Nordics.

Our facilities include one main room (reserved), one breakout room (reserved), and several informal spaces throughout the building's lobby areas that can be used for smaller discussion sessions (not reserved).

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Contribution inspirations

You are allowed to come with a question instead of a solution.

- Introduction to how my team/organization works.
- Cool procedure/practice/tool we have developed.
- Cool software I have developed.
- Book/video/event review and summary.
- Problem or concern I am facing now.
- Demo or poster about something you would like to have input on.

You can request how long your session should be: lightning talk (10 min), 20 min talk, poster/demo spot. You will get to know your assigned length in time before the event.

Unconference

We'll also set aside time for an unconference: sessions that can be proposed or requested on the spot during the event. Maybe you'll invite someone to run a session inspired by an informal coffee conversation, or you'll discover that several attendees are curious to hear more about something you're working on. The unconference time is meant exactly for those spontaneous, interest-driven sessions.

Schedule

When to attend

- **For the Finnish-RSE meetup**, attend lunch on 2 Feb to lunch or dinner on 3 Feb.
- **For the SciComp team meetup**, attend 3 Feb until lunch on Feb 4.
- The overlapping day is events of interest to both groups.
- You are of course welcome to attend more, if you would like.

Schedule

Timetable

Monday (2 February)

	Palaver Main room	Klondyke Parallel room	Other
13:00	RSE meetup intro Samantha Wittke, Richard Darst		
13:30	Sharing GIS Tools Across Disciplines: Hard Choices, Opportunities, and Trade-offs Kamyar Hasanzadeh		
11:30	Arrival and registration Registration and lunch info	TargetCAT: When a Script Refuses to Stay Small Ina Pöhner, Rafael Lopes Almeida	
14:30 12:00			Break Lunch (included) With coffee & small snacks 2nd floor, Metso restaurant (not Reima student restaurant)
15:00	Discussion session Topic TBD		

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14:30 12:00			Break Lunch (included) With coffee & small snacks 2nd floor, Metso restaurant (not Reima student restaurant)
15:00	Discussion session Topic TBD		
16:00	Laptop session Luca Ferranti		
17:00	End of day Rooms remain available		
18:00			Dinner Fat Lizard (own expense, confirm participation by afternoon coffee break)

Tuesday (3 February)

	Palaver Main room	Klondyke Parallel room	Other
09:30	Keynote - The RSE community in the United Kingdom Jeremy Cohen		
10:30			Break With coffee & small snacks
10:45	Towards FAIR file formats: a case example with Origin & Python Julia Niskanen Realization: it's SymPy Frankie Robertson		
13:00	SciComp team meetup intro Richard Darst, Samantha Wittke		
11:45	RSE meetup wrapup Samantha Wittke, Richard Darst		
13:10	Cool things and problems Darst facilitates, everyone may present		
12:00			Lunch (self-paid) 2nd floor, Metso restaurant (not Reima student restaurant)
13:45	Role of SciComp and RSEs Heikki Manila		
14:30			Break With coffee & small snacks

13:00	**It's SymPy SciComp team meetup intro** Frankie Robertson, Richard Darst, Samantha Wittke		
11:45 13:10	**RSE meetup wrapup** Samantha Wittke, Richard Darst		
	Cool things and problems facilitates, everyone may present		
12:00 13:45	**Role of SciComp and RSEs** Heikki Manila		**Lunch (self-paid)** 2nd floor, Metso restaurant (not Reima student restaurant)
14:30			**Break** With coffee & small snacks
14:45	**Unconference: How can we get users to ask for help?**	**Unconference: Everything, everywhere, all at once** If "AI" can mean anything, how do we support "AI"? [Slides] (https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1gHIibVQdsvu1YoKDVtzleL1MZCvsWuXTqASLeeLRXCU/edit)	
15:45	**Hardest legal questions** Maria Rehbinder		
16:30	**(session)** Further discussion		
17:00	**End of day** Rooms remain available		
18:00			**Dinner** Itsuyaka, Tapiola (own expense, confirm participation by afternoon coffee break)

Wednesday (4 February)

	Palaver Main room	Klondyke Parallel room	Other
09:30	**Unconference: VSCode and AI agents on HPC?** Should we embrace, accept, prohibit, or ...?		
10:00	**Panel discussion: Scientific computing experience** Further discussion with the panelists		**Break** With only small snacks
10:45	**Unconference: hallway track**		
11:00	**Unconference: OpenCompose on OnDemand** Demonstration of the job composer **Unconference: keeping the community going** We'd like to meet again in a year, now what?		
11:45	**Concluding remarks**		
12:00			**Lunch (self-paid)** 2nd floor, Metso restaurant (not Reima

10:00	**Panel discussion: scientific computing experience** Further discussion with the panelists **Unconference: hallway track**		**Break** With only small snacks
10:45	**Unconference: OpenCompose on OnDemand** Demonstration of the job composer		
11:00	**Unconference: keeping the community going** We'd like to meet again in a year, now what?		
11:45	Concluding remarks		
12:00			**Lunch (self-paid)** 2nd floor, Metso restaurant (not Reima student restaurant)
13:00	Local team funding discussion (if there is any interest - no plans yet)		

List of sessions

This list currently only has the pre-planned “keynote” sessions invited by the organizers for the SciComp meetup (the second half).

Monday (2 February)

RSE meetup intro

- *Contributors: Samantha Wittke, Richard Darst*
- *Time, Location: 13:00, Palaver*

Introductory words.

Sharing GIS Tools Across Disciplines: Hard Choices, opportunities, and Trade-offs

- *Contributors: Kamyar Hasanzadeh*
- *Time, Location: 13:30, Palaver*

As GIS methods spread into interdisciplinary research, researchers are increasingly expected to package their workflows as usable software for others. In practice, this is far from straightforward. This talk reflects on several common ways of sharing GIS tools—commercial extensions (e.g. ArcGIS toolboxes), open-source plugins (QGIS), standalone desktop applications, web apps, and simply releasing code—and the challenges that come with each. These include technical maintenance, licensing constraints, usability for non-GIS experts, reproducibility, institutional dependencies, and long-term sustainability. Rather than advocating a single solution, the talk examines both the advantages and the challenges of each approach, using these trade-offs as a starting point for discussion on how researchers and research software engineers can make more realistic and context-aware decisions when sharing GIS methods for interdisciplinary use.

TargetCAT: When a Script Refuses to Stay Small

- *Contributors: Ina Pöhner, Rafael Lopes Almeida*
- *Time, Location: 13:30, Palaver*

What began as a small collection of personal scripts to manage and process data on potential drug targets refused to stay small. It quietly turned into a research pipeline that enabled several publications and projects, while itself remaining far from ideal in many places.

In this talk, we use TargetCAT as a case study to explore how research software typically evolves in academic projects: how it survives, grows, and gradually accumulates technical debt. We reflect on familiar patterns such as ad-hoc workflows, "ghost development" carried out outside funded time, and feature creep driven by scientific needs without corresponding resources. Along the way, the story touches on identity challenges faced by researchers whose work is effectively research software engineering, but is assessed through publication-centred metrics.

Imagine a project where a handful of researchers all try to do the same thing - except everyone does it manually, in their own way, and the one automated step crashes regularly due to poor error handling. Out of frustration with this fragile setup, TargetCAT was born.

The second half of the talk turns to a reboot of TargetCAT as an open-source pipeline for an academic–industry collaboration. In this part, we share how earlier missteps and constraints, together with a fresh developer perspective and a conscious commitment to RSE practices from the outset, are shaping its second life. We conclude by teasing lessons learned and

reproducibility, institutional dependencies, and long-term sustainability. Rather than advocating a single solution, the talk examines both the advantages and the challenges of each approach, using these trade-offs as a starting point for discussion on how researchers and research software engineers can make more realistic and context-aware decisions when sharing GIS methods for interdisciplinary use.

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Laptop session

- *Contributors: Luca Ferranti*
- *Time, Location: 16:00, Palaver*

Do you have something cool on your laptop you can't wait to share with others? Have ever been frustrated at traditional poster sessions thinking "This would be much cooler if I could demo from my PC". Join our first "Laptop session", everyone with a computer can join and showcase a demo of something they are proud of, doesn't matter if it is a project, your dot files or something else, join to share with others in a chill environment.

Dinner

- *Time, Location: 18:00, Other*

We have a dinner reservation at Fat Lizard restaurant. Confirm your spot by the afternoon coffee break. You can preview the menu here

Address: Tietotie 1 (~10-15 minute walk away). The menu will suit almost all diets (note it's a more limited menu than the for small groups).

Tuesday (3 February)

Keynote - The RSE community in the United Kingdom

- *Contributors: Jeremy Cohen*
- *Time, Location: 09:30, Palaver*

Jeremy Cohen is an Advanced Research Fellow in the Department of Computing and Director of Research Software Engineering Strategy at Imperial College London. He has been involved in the Research Software Engineering community since the early days and held a research software development role in a research group prior to the creation of the "RSE" term. He has a PhD in Computing from Imperial and held one of the 5-year Research Software Engineering Fellowships (from 2018) that were funded by the UK Engineering and Physical Sciences Research Council (EPSRC). Jeremy is currently involved in a set of different grants relating to RSE and the wider "digital Research Technical Professionals" (dRTP) space that's developing in the UK to recognise not just RSEs but also research data and research computing infrastructure professionals. He is the PI of STFC-UKP (https://stfc-ukp.ac.uk), an EPSRC-funded Strategic Technical Platform with a regional focus on developing skills, community and career pathways for dRTPs.

In his talk, Jeremy will discuss how Research Software Engineering has developed within the UK. He will highlight various challenges and opportunities around developing skills and career pathways for RSEs. He will then look at how the RSE community is expanding to represent a wider group of dRTPs in a range of technical roles who provide vital contributions to support and undertake modern digital research.

Towards FAIR file formats: a case example with Origin & Python

- *Contributors: Juha Niskanen*
- *Time, Location: 10:45, Palaver*

Open Science and FAIR principles have become increasingly important in the last decade. However, the implementation of interoperability is sometimes challenged by established software and analytical practices. One example of such established software is Origin (OriginLab Corporation, Northampton, Massachusetts, USA), an analysis software with various features involving graphing, statistical operations, and data processing and transformation. Origin output files are comprehensive and can contain entire analysis pipelines, however, the file format (.opju) is proprietary, the software is restricted to Windows and requires a paid license to access all features, and there's no easy option to export all the contents of the file to other formats. Together, these factors impede the implementation of interoperability. To overcome these obstacles, I have developed a lightweight Python tool, convert-opj, that can begin within Origin to quickly and systematically export graphs, images, workbooks, matrices and notes to open file formats

Towards FAIR file formats: a case example with Origin & Python

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- *Time, Location: 10:45, Palaver*

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Realization: it's SymPy

- *Contributors: Frankie Robertson*
- *Time, Location: 10:45, Palaver*

SymPy looks nice, but it's not a real CAS... is it? In this presentation I hope to show that as well as SymPy scaling down, SymPy is quite a capable CAS for helping to tackle real world problems we might encounter as RSEs. The main content of the presentation is a case study of how SymPy has been a useful tool during my first project as an RSE, working on a simulation of a mass spectrometer, both as a tool for ad-hoc tool enabling DRY and --- using more of its power --- to help design more efficient numerical sampling code. So next time you have some maths to wrangle, I say: "Go on: treat yourself!" (to SymPy)

RSE meetup wrapup

- *Contributors: Samantha Wittke, Richard Darst*
- *Time, Location: 11:45, Palaver*

Closing words.

SciComp team meetup intro

- *Contributors: Richard Darst, Samantha Wittke*
- *Time, Location: 13:00, Palaver*

Introductory words. Slides.

Cool things and problems

- *Contributors: Samantha Wittke, Everyone may present*
- *Time, Location: 13:10, Palaver*

Slides

What is the role of Research Software Engineers, and teams of them, in universities in the future? Heikki Mäntylä was president of the Research Council of Finland (the Academy of Finland) from 2012-2022 and organized one of the "House of Art" are Aalto projects helping to create a cross-disciplinary problem-solving and scientific culture. We will quickly go through the Finnish side of things, aiming point for discussion - maybe a few minute talks if requested from attendees.

Role of SciComp and RSEs

- *Contributors: Heikki Mäntylä*
- *Time, Location: 13:45, Palaver*

Discussion: The current hardest legal questions in research data and computing

- *Contributors: Maria Rehbinder*
- *Time, Location: 15:45, Palaver*

The session will be with presentations and slide decks. Attendees will get contribution instructions (+ more details) closer to the event.

Software development in research groups is a topic of the "RSE" term. He has a PhD in Computing from Imperial and held one of the 5-year Research Software Engineering Fellowships (from 2018) that were funded by the UK Engineering and Physical Sciences Research Council (EPSRC). Jeremy is currently involved in a set of different grants relating to RSE and FAIR wider "Digital Research Technical Professionals" (dRTP) space that's developing in the UK to recognise not just RSEs but also research data and research computing infrastructure professionals. He is the PI of STFC UKP (https://stfc.ukp.ac.uk), an EPSRC funded Strategic Technical Platform with a regional focus on developing skills, community and career pathways for dRTPs.

In his talk, Jeremy will discuss how Research Software Engineering has developed within the UK. He will highlight various challenges and opportunities around developing skills and career pathways for RSEs. He will then look at how the RSE community is expanding to represent a wider group of dRTPs in a range of technical roles who provide vital contributions to support and undertake modern digital research.

Role of SciComp and RSEs

- *Contributors: Everyone may present*
- *Time, Location: 13:10, Palaver*

Slides

What is the role of Research Software Engineers, and teams of them, in universities in the future? We will talk about the work done and the research council of Finland (the Academy of Finland) from 2012-2022 in organizing the creation of the "House of AI", and what things they helped to create, and what kind of lessons we learned from this. We will quickly go through the funders side of things, and give some vision on how research engineer and talent can be nurtured from an funding point of view.

Discussion: The current hardest legal questions in research data and computing

- *Contributors: Maria Rehbinder*
- *Time, Location: 15:45, Palaver*

We often hear clear-cut instructions about legal matters in research (copyright, data, ethics, intellectual property, and especially AI these days). Yet humans are behind the scenes, reading and interpreting the legislation, court cases and legal literature and producing these guidelines, and it isn't always so clear-cut. This is a discussion with Maria Rehbinder, Legal Counsel, Aalto University, where we'll peek "behind the curtains" at some of the open questions going around right now, especially related to AI. This will start a two-way discussion about all of these legal matters.

Maria Rehbinder is a Senior Legal Counsel at Aalto University. Her traditional standard projects included copyright, trademarks, and design rights, but more recently has been involved in the initial implementation work of legislation such as the GDPR, AI Act, and Digital Services Act. Maria serves as a member in the Copyright Commission and the Copyright Council of the Ministry of Education and Culture and as a member in the Rights Management Committee of Open Research and Science 2014-2017 initiative of the ministry.

Dinner

- *Time, Location: 18:00, Other*

We have a dinner reservation at the Itsuyaka restaurant. Confirm your spot by the afternoon coffee break.

It has a buffet with many Asian-type foods. It's at the Ainoa shopping center at the Tapiola metro station, the building above the metro station, third floor. It's one metro stop or a 30 minute walk.

Wednesday (4 February)

Panel discussion: Junior researcher's experience of scientific and HPC and computing

- *Time, Location: 10:00, Palaver*

How can universities get infrastructure funding for local Research Software Engineer support. How can they work together? This is a discussion, taking into account everything we have learned at the workshop, to make some plans on what comes next. Can we apply as a Finnish Research Infrastructure? Can we form an international NeIC project for this? Any EU opportunities? Is it better to start local? With large computing clusters taking all the hype, what's the role of local people? We will try to figure this out.

Panel discussions are usually full of the most senior people the organizers can find. In this discussion, we'll hear from junior researchers, about how usable they find computing systems and the onboarding process.

Concluding remarks

- *Time, Location: 11:45, Palaver*

Slides

Thank you!

Thanks to all attendees, speakers, and unconference hosts. We had a good meet-up, lots of engaging discussions, and formed the seed of a community. We plan a repeat in Tampere (or Turku) in January 2027, and maybe some online get-together before then.

Local team funding discussion

- *Time, Location: 13:00, Palaver*

Nordic Basic Scientific Computing is a gathering of everyone interested in supporting scientific computing (and a celebration of the diverse work that makes it all possible). Aalto Scientific Computing invites you to its homebase at Otaniemi Campus, 2-4 February 2026.

We don't know if anyone will be interested in discussing this. If there is no explicit requests, it is safe to assume this won't happen.

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- *Time, Location: 11:45, Palaver*

Slides

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Thanks to all attendees, speakers, and unconference hosts. We had a good meet-up, lots of engaging discussions, and formed the seed of a community. We plan a repeat in Tampere (or Turku) in January 2027, and maybe some online get-together before then.

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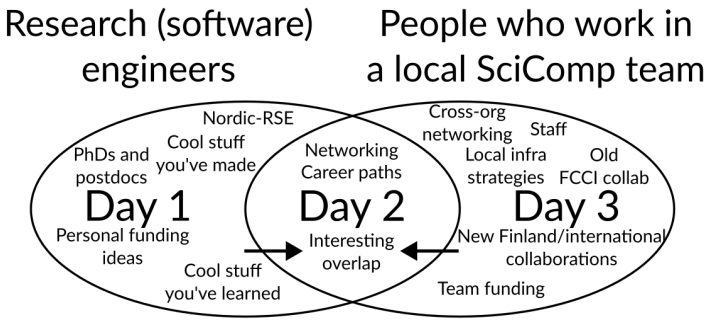
This event is split into two halves: **The first half is a** Finnish+friends RSE meetup **, the second half is a** meetup of Finnish scientific computing teams more targeted to service staff**. The overlapping middle day has events that are interesting to both audiences. People are welcome to attend both halves.**



This event focuses on practical discussion and experience-sharing in the world of RSE and SciComp. Whether you develop research software, support researchers through local computing services or you are simply curious about these roles, this is gathering for you. It's a time to roll up our sleeves, look under the hood and talk about what's really going on.

Schedule (general plan)

See also

Schedule

- Day 1 (Mo, 2 Feb 2026): RSE meetup, starting with lunch at 12
- Day 2 (Tu, 3 Feb 2026): RSE/SciComp overlap day: events, lunch, evening dinner, some social activities scattered between.
- Day 3 (We: 4 Feb 2026): SciComp team meetup: events 9-12, lunch.

Quick info

See also

Practical info

Key Dates:

- 5 December: Registration opens (closes when full)
- Rolling acceptance of talks, posters/demos
- 20 January: Abstract submission deadline (every suitable abstract submitted until this date will get a spot in the program)
- 21 January: Talk length decided (latest)
- 2-4 February: Nordic Basic Scientific Computing event

Location: Dipoli, Otaniemi Campus, Aalto University, Espoo, Helsinki area, Finland

RSE-FI flyer, SciComp teams flyer

Price: Free

Program: You can submit talks and other events in advance, but we also plan an "unconference session" (program decided by attendees)..

Registration

We will provide lunch times for coffee break and lunches and make sure that everyone can find an engaging group to be a part of.

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RSE-FI flyer, SciComp teams flyer

Program: You can submit talks and other events in advance, but we also plan an "unconference session" (program decided by attendees)..

The event is intended to be relatively small to facilitate networking.

Online attendance: We've chosen to hold this event in person only, as we believe it offers the best environment for meaningful networking and a more engaging, collaborative atmosphere.

Registration link

https://indico.neic.no/event/284/registrations/

Quick info

See also

Practical info

Registration

Price: Free

We will provide longtimes for coffee breaks and lunches and make sure that everyone can find an engaging group to be a part of.